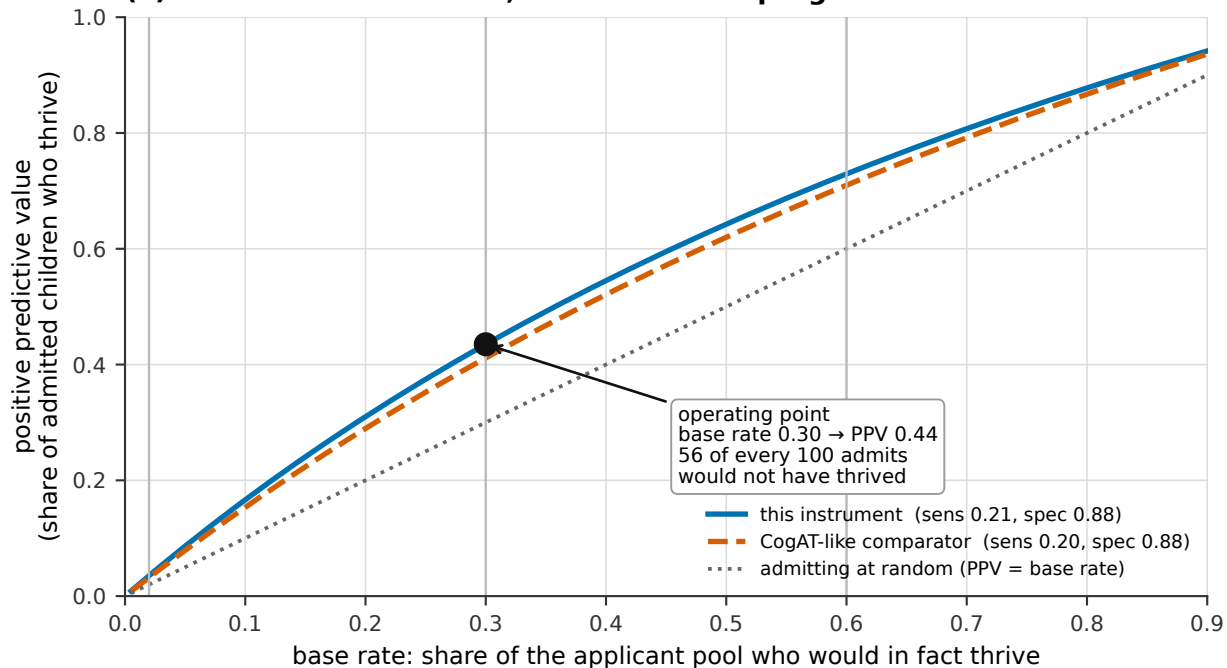
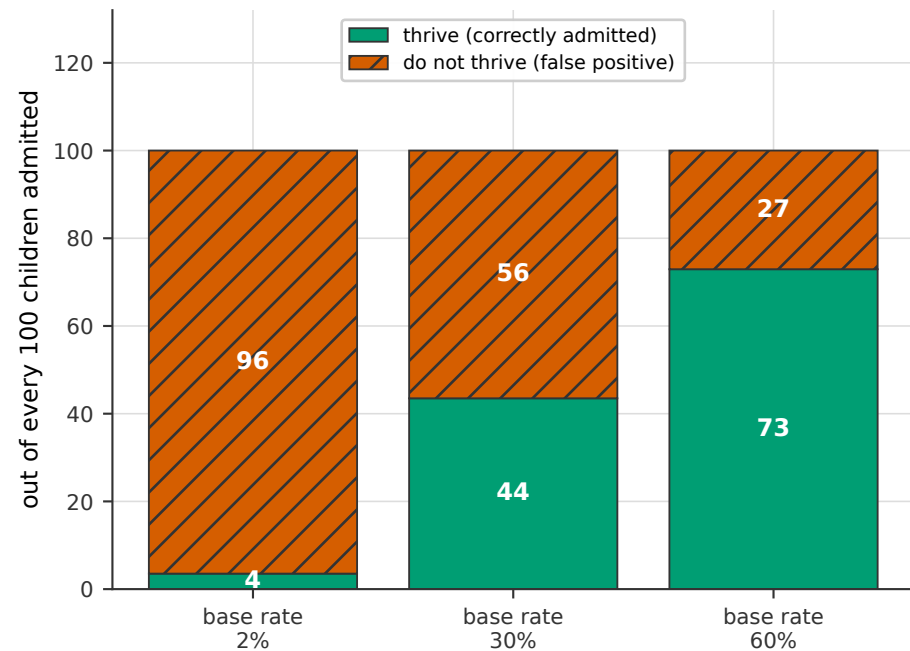


(a) The same instrument, three different programmes



(b) What that means for 100 admitted children



Nothing about the instrument changes across this figure — only the population it is used on. At the conventional top-2% gifted prevalence the same instrument at the same threshold has a positive predictive value of 0.04, meaning about 96 of every 100 admitted children would not have thrived. A programme cannot buy its way out of this with a better test; it is arithmetic about who is in the pool, and it is the reason the selection ratio and the base rate must be published alongside any accuracy claim.